

Comparative Basket Views

Better understanding competitive basket costs

January 2026



Customer Comparative Basket Views: We are getting a sense on price comparison from the customer point of view

Why are we doing it?

- **Price competitiveness and perception is the most important factor to get right** as we fight to gain momentum, especially as costs to consumers re-accelerate in 2026
- **Price indices are a useful tool** for us to remain competitive, **however they may mask cost differences** that come to life in how customers shop
- Our price perception vs. Coles in particular remains challenged

What do we have so far?

- Group Customer in collaboration with B&M and Commercial has **developed sample baskets and customer profiles** to test
- Executed test shops across 5 missions at WW, Coles and Aldi (n=3)
- Tests show that some price differences come down to **pack differences in aisle alongside promo and base price differences**
- **Current approach is manual** and does not yield sufficient sample to draw conclusions that we can act on

What's next?

- Investigating **agentic solution** to scale baskets and sample size, alongside an outsourced option to calibrate our synthetic customers and validate results

Basket comparative views from promo week 18 Feb

		Seek well known, familiar brands		Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price		
		Traditional		Saver		
Total (All Shopping missions)		Spaghetti Bolognese	Hosting a BBQ	School Lunch	"Choice" basket	Full weekly shop
Woolworths basket price	\$449.2	\$63.9	\$71.1	\$62.1	\$75.3	\$176.9
coles vs WW	-\$1.9 -0.4%	-\$2.9 -4.5%	+\$10.4 14.6%	+\$0.25 0.4%	-\$3.0 -4.0%	-\$4.4 -2.5%
ALDI vs WW	-\$37.5 -8.3%	-\$6.3 -9.9%	-\$2.7 -3.8%	-\$11.0 -17.6%	-\$5.4 -7.1%	-\$12.1 -6.9%

Primary cost difference drivers

Generally **pack sizes** and **promotions**

Pack size: Lean mince beef 1kg WW vs 800g Coles

Promotions (e.g. soft drinks on promo at WW)

Pack size (e.g. some larger pack sizes at Coles); Aldi packaged cold meat

Promotions (e.g. Royal Gala on promo at Coles); Lower grade mince at Aldi

Pack sizes - same price per kg but variations in weight (eg chicken breast WW 1.5kg vs Coles 1.3kg)

Comparative basket testing

Primary baskets

Mission	1 "I need to make Spaghetti Bolognese"	2 "I need to pack school lunches for next week"	3 "I'm hosting a BBQ for 6 people."	4 Saver family weekly top up shop
Rationale	Most common home cooked meal	Back to school late Jan	Summer seasonal occasions, entertaining	Price/cost of living focused common weekly shop
Customer Segment & Behaviours	Traditional, Family Seek well known, familiar brands, prefer smaller pack size rather than switch brand	Saver, Family Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price	Conscious, Singles and Couples Lean towards convenience items, check product labels	Saver, Family Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price
Basket items	- Lean Mince beef, 1kg - Spaghetti / Dry pasta, 500g - Pasta sauce, 500g - Tomato paste, 140g tub - Brown onions, 1kg - Mushrooms, 200g - Carrots, 1kg - Parmesan cheese, shaved 200g - Garlic bread, twin pack ~450g - Olive oil, 700ml	- Sandwich bread, 1 loaf ~700g - Wraps, pack of 8 - Deli ham, 600g - Applies, 1kg - Bananas, 1kg - White seedless grapes, 1kg - Tasty cheese block, 500g - Yoghurt pouches, 12 x 100g - Muesli bars, 6 bar box (185g) - Multipack chips, 6-pack - Juice boxes, 6x250ml pack - Sandwich bags, 40 pack box	- Beef sausages, 1kg - Beef hamburger patties, 6 pack - Sandwich bread, 1 loaf ~700g - Hamburger rolls, x6 - Tomato sauce, 500ml - BBQ sauce, 500ml - Coleslaw salad kit, ~450g - Potato salad, ~500g pre pack - Paper plates, 20 pack - Paper towels, 2 pack - Soft drink, multipack cans 10 x 375ml - Potato chips, 2x 165g	- Sandwich bread, 1 loaf ~700g - Bananas, 1kg - Strawberries, 2x250g - Onions, 1kg - Tomatoes, 1kg - Apples, 1kg - Minced beef, 1kg - Chicken breast, 1kg - Full cream milk, 3L - Kids yoghurt pouches, 10x70g - Dry pasta, 500g - Bolognese pasta sauce, 500g - Loose washed potatoes, 1kg - Potato chips, 2x 165g - Muesli bars, 6pk, 185g

Comparative basket testing

External reference baskets

Mission

5

The *Choice* basket

CHOICE

6

Sunrise Australia Day BBQ



Rationale

Well known reference basket

Recent publicity in morning TV

Customer Segment & Behaviours

Traditional, Family

Seek well known, familiar brands, prefer smaller pack size rather than switch brand

Saver, Family

Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price

Basket items

- Chicken breasts, bulk pack (1kg)
- Carrots, 1kg
- Royal Gala apples, 1kg
- Cavendish bananas, 1kg
- Strawberries, 250g
- Full cream milk, 3L
- Weetbix, 1kg
- Beef mince, 1kg
- Block of tasty cheese, 1kg
- Sliced white bread, 650g
- Penne pasta, 500g
- Tinned diced tomatoes, 400g
- Frozen peas, 1kg
- Tea bags, 100 pack
- Brown onions, 1kg

- Lamb cutlets, 1kg
- Beef sausages, 1kg
- Beef burger patties, 6 pack
- Chicken drumsticks, 1kg
- Sunscreen, 250ml tube
- Paddle pops, 8 pack
- Kettle chips, 175g
- White bread, 650g loaf
- Tomato sauce, 500ml
- Coca-Cola, 1.25L

Comparative basket testing

Additional baskets for consideration

Mission	7 Easter shop (incl confectionary)	8 Full weekly shop
Rationale	Key event	Price/cost of living focused common weekly shop
Customer Segment & Behaviours	Saver, Family Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price	Saver, Family Seek weekly specials, shop by unit prices, will consider own brand for lower price
Basket items	- Hot cross buns (Traditional), 6 pack - Hot cross buns (Chocolate), 6 pack - Solid chocolate eggs, 125g - 150g - Hollow hunting easter eggs, 170g (10 pack) - Chocolate rabbit (gold bunny), 100g - Double brie cheese, 200g - Strawberries, 250g - Pancake shaker, 325g - Maple syrup, 250ml - Fresh salmon fillet, 200g - Prawns (thawed), 1kg - Boneless Pork Leg Roast, 1kg	- Sandwich bread, 1 loaf ~700g - Bananas, 1kg - Strawberries, 2x250g - Onions, 1kg - Tomatoes, 1kg - Apples, 1kg - Minced beef, 1kg - Chicken breast, 1kg - Full cream milk, 3L - Kids yoghurt pouches, 10x70g - Dry pasta, 500g - Bolognese pasta sauce, 500g - Loose washed potatoes, 1kg - Potato chips, 2x 165g - Muesli bars, 6pk, 185g - Laundry liquid, 2L - Dishwashing liquid, 1L - Dishwashing tabs, 40pk - Toilet tissue, 24pk - Avocado Hass x1 - Spreadable butter, 500g - Shredded tasty cheese, 700g - Free range eggs, 700g, 12pk - Thickened cream, 600ml - Frozen meal, 1x375g - Nappies, size 3, 40 to 56pk - Baby wipes, 80pk - Flavoured tuna, 95g - Weet-bix, 1.2kg - Juice (non-refrigerated), 2L - Spring water, 24x600ml

Appendix